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Collection Manager - Section of Birds

Carnegie Museum of Natural History - Oakland, 4400 Forbes Avenue, Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, United States of America Req #648

Date Posted: Friday, September 3, 2021

Carnegie Museum of Natural History, one of the four Carnegie Museums of Pittsburgh, is among the top natural history museums in the country. It maintains, preserves, and interprets an extraordinary collection of artifacts, objects, and scientific specimens used to broaden understanding of evolution, conservation, and biodiversity. Carnegie Museum of Natural History generates new scientific knowledge, advances science literacy, and inspires visitors of all ages to become passionate about science, nature, and world cultures.

Carnegie Museums of Pittsburgh is interested in candidates who, through their experience and collaborations, will contribute to diversity and excellence of the Carnegie Museums community.

Collection Manager for the Section of Birds is responsible for the physical care, maintenance, and preservation of the bird collection, and to maintain and improve specimen records and databases. This position is responsible for incoming and outgoing loans, overseeing the preparation and integration of new specimens, and facilitating the use of the collection by researchers and other visitors. The Collection Manager will also train and supervise other personnel, volunteers, and work study students in day-to-day tasks, including georeferencing, physical organization of specimens, and collection-based research projects. Requests for loans and data must be handled in a timely manner with appropriate documentation. This position will support the needs of CMNH exhibitions, education programming, and marketing.

Other responsibilities may include participating in identifying funding opportunities and working closely with the curator in obtaining funding. Additional internal and external service may be included as part of an annual plan. Participation in professional development activities to further knowledge of collection stewardship is expected. A desire to conduct research up to or less than 10% is encouraged, but not required, and can be negotiated at the time of hiring. Collection Manager of Birds will contribute substantially to strategic development and the execution of the long-term collections plan.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Minimum qualifications for this position are an advanced degree in a natural science field, bioinformatics, or museum studies from an accredited university with at least three years of work experience in a systematic collection.
- Previous work experience involving day-to-day management of a biological collection and familiarity with specimen preparation, avian taxonomy and systematics is essential.
- A record of effective science communication and project management is also desirable.
- Working knowledge of scientific principles and practices, with special emphasis on techniques, procedures, best practices, and professional standards for bird species identification, specimen preparation, specimen handling and storage, and scientific data management preferred.
- Candidate should have a working knowledge of external data repositories such as GBIF, iDigBio, and MorphoSource and can work on iterative tasks over lengthy periods of time with minimal supervision.
- An understanding of relevant regulatory laws, compliance procedures, and facility security related to collections and artifacts is essential.
- Necessary computer skills include word processing, manipulation of large databases in Access, and basic knowledge in one or more computer coding languages (e.g., R, MatLab, Python, etc.).
- Must be able to work independently and collaboratively and establish and maintain a culture of collaboration with co-workers, supervisors, and the public.
- Effective oral and written science communication skills are also an important part of educational programming responsibilities.
- Ability to read written Spanish and familiarity with birds from Central and South America is desirable.
- A successful applicant must be detail oriented for accuracy of data and should also have experience with bird identification and preparation of study skins, fluid specimens and skeletons, and dermestid husbandry and be motivated to develop and seek funding to expand the bird collection using the extended specimen framework (e.g., stomach contents, nests, pollen loads, feces, feather samples, quantifying plumage color, and digitizing data from historical surveys and archival materials).

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- While performing the duties of this job, the employee is frequently required to walk, sit, talk, and hear. The employee is occasionally required to use hands to handle specimens and operate tools or controls and use arms to reach. Drawers to be manipulated will be located up to 10 feet high (must have ability to climb a rolling ladder). The employee is occasionally required to climb or balance, stoop, kneel, crouch, or crawl. Basic manual dexterity with both hands required.
- The employee performs duties in a wide variety of settings including office, collection area, and public galleries. The noise level in the work environment will vary accordingly.
- The employee must occasionally lift and/or move up to 40 pounds. Specific vision abilities required by this job include close vision, distance vision, color vision, peripheral vision, depth perception, and the ability to adjust focus.
- The work environment characteristics described here are representative of those an employee encounters while performing the essential functions of this job. Reasonable accommodations may be made to enable individuals with disabilities to perform the essential functions.
- Must be able to work with ethanol and other chemicals and is regularly exposure to dust, chemicals, fumes, and sharp instruments.

ESSENTIAL FUNCTIONS

- Duties include care of the collections, database management and improvement, documentation and processing of loans, preparing and cataloging new specimens, assisting visitors, participating in other museums programs as appropriate.
- Expected to promote and ensure the conservation, preparation, care, use and security of the collection. Should have a commitment to expand and contribute to use of the ornithology collection in research, education, and outreach.
- Position will maintain a complete database of all specimens/objects and monitor their storage conditions, including but not limited to temperature and humidity levels, pest infestation, and cleanliness. Must also handle the receipt, preparation, cataloging, accessioning, and integrating of new specimens. Must also be familiar and comply with the museum collections management policy.
- Duties include training, managing, and working with undergraduate work study student assistants, interns, and volunteers to carry out curation activities and specimen preparation. There may be on-the-exhibit-floor support of events, classes, identification requests, and offsite lectures or field trips. Expected to give tours of the collection. Participate in a broad range of museum activities including exhibits programs, and internal and external educational activities.
- Provide support for activities in other departments – including exhibits, education and museum committee work, and external service (e.g., professional society membership and officer positions, consultations, peer review, participation in museum programs, workshops, seminars, and other forms of professional development in the museum profession).

ADDITIONAL QUALIFICATIONS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

- Assist in grant-proposal preparations for collection-related projects.
- Coordinating and managing permits relating to collection activities.
- Operating and maintaining the dermestid skeletal preparation facility.
- Care for fluid collection and be familiar with laws regarding packing of fluid specimens on loan.
- Excellent communications skills and an innate ability to engage and enthuse the public and stakeholders through their work.
- Has the ability to work independently or as part of a team and who has excellent organizational skills and a detail-oriented approach to work.
- Basic knowledge of museum practices and standards for collection care; excellent oral, written, supervisory, and mechanical skills.
- Computer skills and the ability to adapt rapidly to changes in technology.
- Ability to interact in a positive and enthusiastic manner with others in the workplace.
- Maintain relationship with the National Aviary, the Audubon Society of Western Pennsylvania, and works closely with the Powdermill Avian Research Center.
- Any other duties as assigned.

The following PA Act 153 clearances, or proof of application of clearances, are required beginning employment and as a condition of continued employment:

- Pennsylvania Child Abuse History Clearance
- Pennsylvania State Police Criminal Record Check
- FBI Fingerprint Criminal Background Check

Obtaining the required clearances is completed as part of the new hire process.

Carnegie Museums is an Equal Opportunity-Affirmative Action Employer – Minorities / Females / Veterans / Individuals with Disabilities / Sexual Orientation / Gender Identity

The above job description reflects the essential functions and qualifications for the position identified, and shall not be construed as a detailed description of all the work requirements that may be inherent in the position. The job description does not constitute an employment contract and does not alter the at-will relationship between CMP and

the employee.

***GUIDANCE ON ESSENTIAL FUNCTIONS:**

The Americans with Disabilities Act ("ADA") requires employers to consider and accommodate qualified individuals with disabilities. An individual is qualified if he or she can perform the essential functions of a job with or without reasonable accommodation. An essential job function is any task that is a fundamental part of the job. When considering essentiality, one must focus upon whether the function is essential to this particular job and not to the department as a whole. Some additional guidance on essential functions follows below. Please note that the following guidelines are non-exhaustive. If you have any questions or need additional guidance, please contact Human Resources.
A. Is the function required to be performed on a regular basis? If the function is rarely performed, it may not be essential.
B. Is the function highly specialized? Is the incumbent hired for his/her expertise or ability to perform the function? The need for special expertise is an indication of an essential function.
C. Does the position exist, at least in part, to perform the function? If so, the function is more likely to be essential.
D. How much time is spent performing the function and how often? Note that even functions performed 10% of the time could be essential if they are required on a regular basis.
E. Would elimination of the function fundamentally alter the job? If so, the function is more likely to be essential.
F. What are the consequences of not requiring the incumbent to perform the function? If they are significant, the function is more likely to be essential.
G. Are there a limited number of employees among whom the performance of the function could be distributed if the incumbent could not perform it? If so, it is more likely to be essential.

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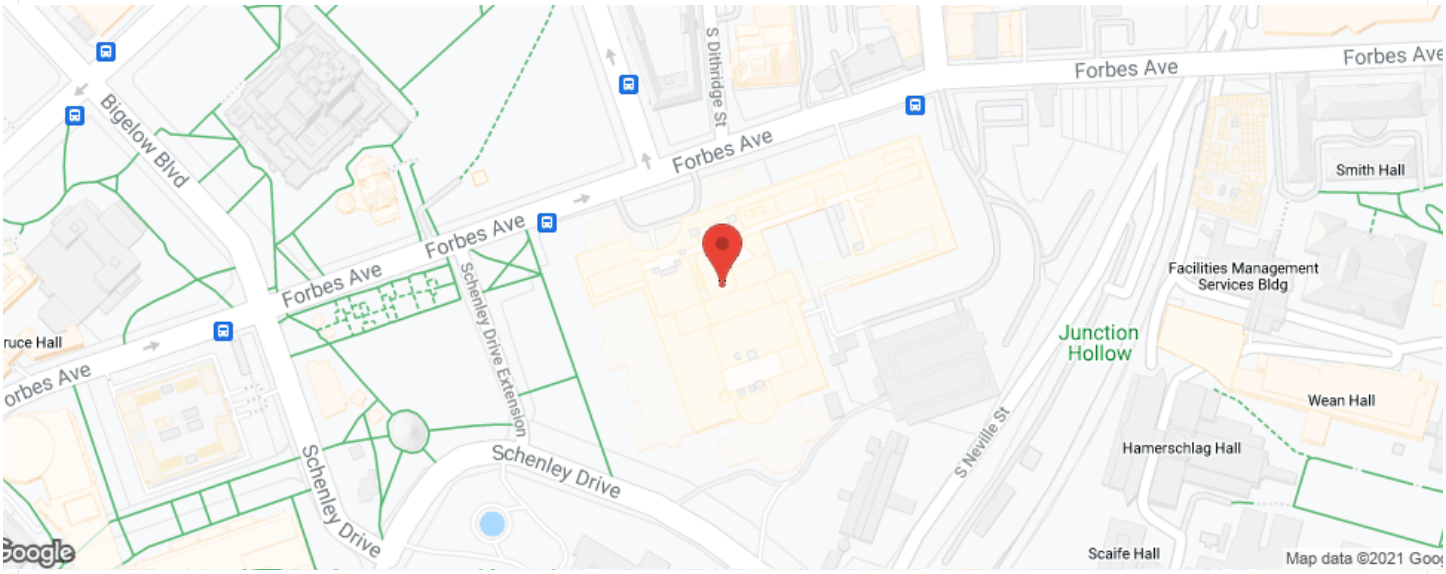

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